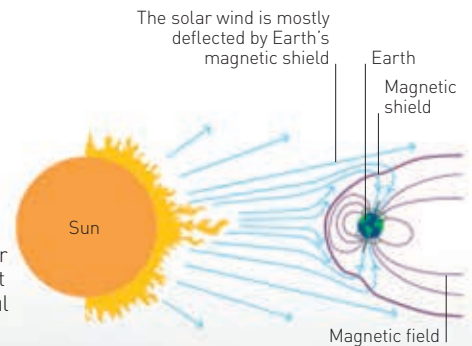


Earth

Formed more than 4.5 billion years ago, Earth is the only place in the Universe known to support life. Its breathable atmosphere, liquid-water oceans, and large areas of dry land support a rich diversity of living things.

MAGNETIC FIELD

With its iron core, Earth acts like an enormous bar magnet with north and south poles. As Earth spins, swirling currents occur in the molten metal within its outer core. This movement generates a powerful magnetic shield.



EARTH'S STRUCTURE

Earth is made up of many different layers. At its centre is a hot, metallic core surrounded by a thick layer of solid but slowly moving rock, called the mantle. Earth's thin crust sits on top.

INNER CORE

This solid iron-nickel alloy core is boiling hot but stays solid due to the extreme pressure at Earth's centre.

OUTER CORE

A layer of liquid iron and nickel surrounds the inner core. It is in constant motion.

MANTLE

The mantle is solid but slowly moves around.

CRUST

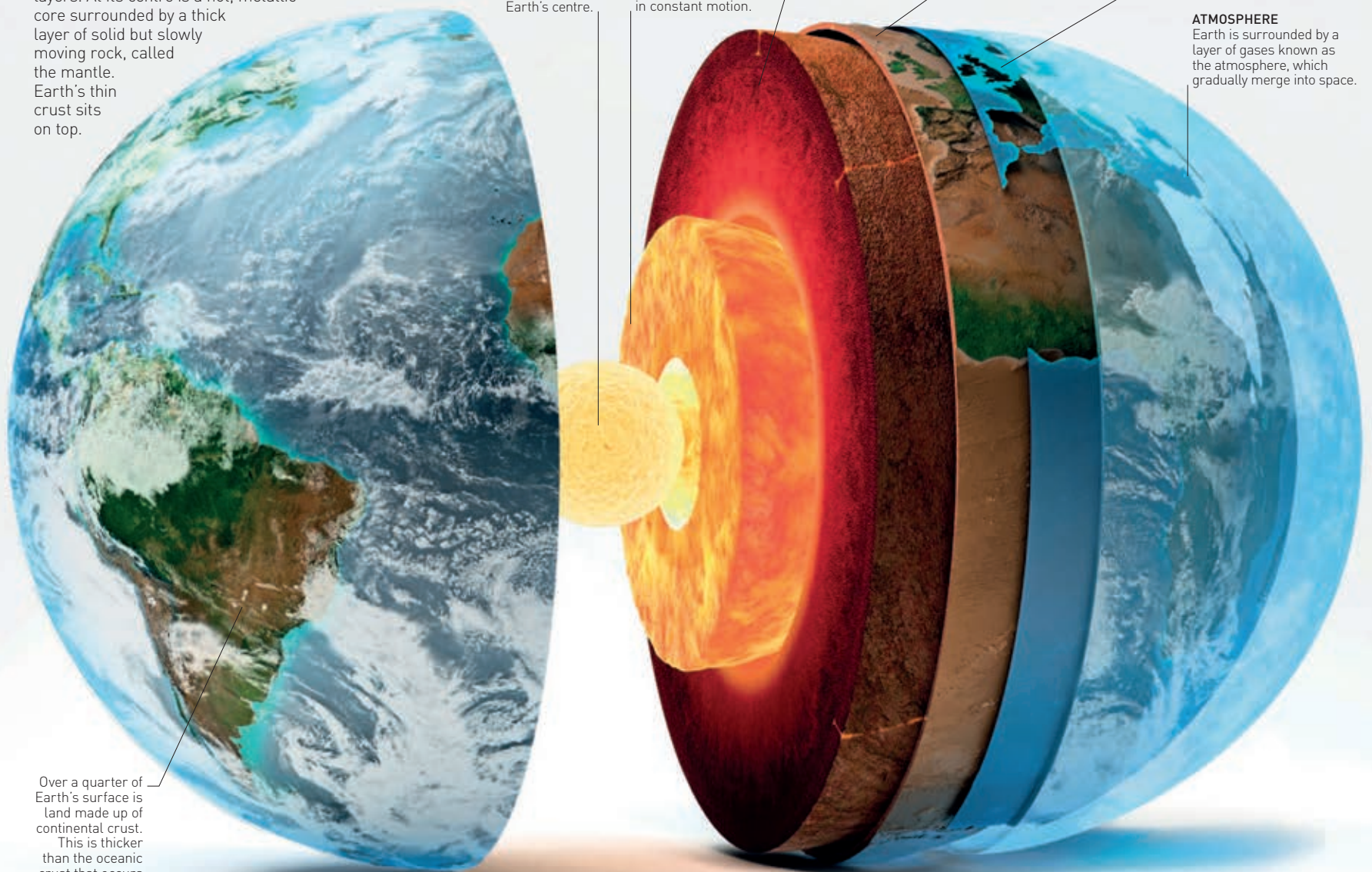
The solid outer layer of Earth is the only part we can see.

OCEAN

Saltwater oceans cover almost three-quarters of Earth's surface.

ATMOSPHERE

Earth is surrounded by a layer of gases known as the atmosphere, which gradually merge into space.



Over a quarter of Earth's surface is land made up of continental crust. This is thicker than the oceanic crust that occurs under the oceans.

HABITATS

Plants and animals live in natural environments on Earth, called habitats. These habitats vary, depending on rainfall, temperature, and location.



OCEAN

The largest habitat on Earth, the ocean is home to as many as a million types of plants and animals.



CORAL REEF

Formed in clear, warm, shallow waters, coral reefs are like beautiful underwater gardens, teeming with marine life.



POLAR REGIONS

With freezing temperatures, the Arctic and Antarctic are the most inhospitable places on Earth.



GRASSLAND

Found on every continent except Antarctica, grassland covers about one-third of Earth's land surface.